P.A. COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING
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ICSR
IOT | CYBER SECURITY | BLOCKCHAIN

IEEE SMC
Systems, Man, and Cybernetics Society

PRESENT

THE FOUNDER'S ARENA

CODE THE SOLUTION. BUILD THE VISION. PITCH THE FUTURE.

A 2-DAY HACKATHON & STARTUP PITCH COMPETITION



20	5	2	2
TEAMS	MEMBERS PER TEAM	DAYS	GRAND PRIZES

DATE
November
17th & 18th, 2026

VENUE
Seminar Hall,
P. A. College of Engineering,
Mangaluru

TIME
9 AM – 4 PM
(Both days)

The top 20 teams shall be selected from the PPT round

Scan the QR on page 4

THE BIG IDEA

What is The Founder's Arena?

A hackathon and Shark Tank rolled into one. In 2 days, your team of 5, spots a real-world problem, builds a working product, creates a startup brand, and pitches to judges who act as investors. You don't just build an app. You build a business.

Build anything: web apps, mobile apps, hardware/IoT, AI solutions or software platforms.

YOUR JOURNEY

1 Pick a domain
Choose 1 of 20 domain sheets

2 Find a problem
A real, meaningful problem worth solving

3 Build & brand
Product, logo, chart paper & promo reel

4 Pitch & win
Present to judges acting as investors

THE 5 ROLES (every teammate gets one)

CEO — Chief Executive Officer
Introduces the startup, vision, mission and long-term goals

CTO — Chief Technology Officer
Explains the tech, demos the product, proves feasibility

CPO — Chief Product Officer
Presents the problem, solution, features and unique value

CFO — Chief Financial Officer
Explains the revenue model, growth and the investment ask

CMO — Chief Marketing Officer
Owns branding, marketing strategy and the promo reel

Judges can ask ANY member anything, so everyone must know the whole product and business.

THE 2-DAY PLAN

DAY 1 — Build Day | Nov 17

- Build a working product with its core features
- Finalise a unique startup name, logo and brand
- Make a physical chart paper presentation
- Produce a 30–60 second promo reel
- Product must be complete by 4:30 PM
- At least 2 teammates stay at the workstation

DAY 2 — Investor Pitch | Nov 18

- Introduce your startup, problem and solution
- Give a live demo of your working product
- Present your chart paper
- Explain your business model and revenue
- State your investment ask and how you will use it
- Answer the judges' questions as a team

SELECTION ROUND

Selection based on a PPT round. Top 20 teams will be selected from screening round

PPT Selection Criteria

Every PPT submission is evaluated on the four criteria below.

DOMAINS

1 DOMAIN 1
Rural Development & Social Innovation

2 DOMAIN 2
FinTech & Financial Inclusion

EVALUATION CRITERIA

1 CRITERION 1
Problem Clarity & Theme Fit
Is the problem clear and real, and does it fit the chosen domain?

2 CRITERION 2
Innovation & Solution Quality
Is the idea original and the solution well thought out?

3 CRITERION 3
Impact & Target Users
Who benefits, and how much difference will it make?

4 CRITERION 4
Technical Feasibility
Can it realistically be built with the proposed tech?

Final scoring weightage will be announced by the organisers.
The above criterias are for the PPT round only.

PPT TEMPLATE

STANDARD PPT TEMPLATE

Prepare your PPT using the official template

Fill in every section and upload the finished PPT through the registration form.

OPEN PPT TEMPLATE

Link: https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1rpwEkuml3yE7qR-lXjFXr9p_FahzhR7d/edit?usp=drive_link&ouid=115607313639692877914&rtpof=true&sd=true

SCAN FOR TEMPLATE

WHAT YOUR CHART PAPER MUST SHOW

1. Startup name and logo
2. Selected domain
3. Problem statement
4. Proposed solution
5. Product overview
6. Key features
7. Target audience
8. Unique selling point (USP)
9. Business model
10. Visuals: screenshots, diagrams, photos

Needed for the final round / pitch evaluation ONLY.

PROMOTIONAL REEL (30–60 SECONDS)

- Introduce your startup and its product
- Show the problem and your solution
- Highlight the key benefits for users
- Use creative storytelling and branding to attract customers and investors

Needed for the final round / pitch evaluation ONLY.

HOW YOU'LL BE JUDGED

Problem and Innovation
Is the problem real and the solution original?

Product and Design
Do the core features work? Is it usable?

Chart and Communication
Is your chart clear and convincing?

Business and Scalability
Clear revenue model, market and growth

Pitch and Teamwork
Structured, confident, well coordinated

Answers to Judges
Can you justify your tech and business choices?

Final scoring weightage will be announced by the organisers.
NOTE: the above judging criterias are for the final/pitch evaluation.

AWARDS

1 **Overall First Place**
Strongest mix of innovation, product, business and pitch.

2 **Overall SecondPlace**
Second-highest overall performance.

READY TO BECOME A FOUNDER?

SCAN TO REGISTER

FOR QUERIES, CONTACT THE FOUNDER

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